Task Sheet No. 11:
TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

INSTRUCTION:

As a pre-service teacher, you are tasked to write a **Teaching Philosophy Essay** that articulates your beliefs, values, and principles about teaching and learning. In your essay, discuss your view of the role of the teacher and learners, how learning takes place, the importance of creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment, and the teaching strategies you believe are most effective. Connect your beliefs to your observations and personal experiences during your Field Study 1 and 2, and relevant educational theories or principles, and explain how these beliefs will guide your future teaching practice. Your essay should be clear, reflective, well-organized, and grounded in your developing professional identity as future educator.

RUBRIC FOR GRADING:

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	PROFICIENT	DEVELOPING	BEGINNING
Teaching and Learning Beliefs (25%)	Clearly and thoughtfully articulates well-developed beliefs about teaching and learning, supported by relevant educational principles or theories.	Clearly presents relevant beliefs about teaching and learning with some connection to educational principles.	Presents general beliefs but provides limited explanation or connection to educational principles.	Provides unclear, limited, or unsupported beliefs about teaching and learning.
Role of Teacher and Learners (25%)	Provides a clear and insightful discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners and their relationship in the learning process.	Clearly discusses the roles of the teacher and learners with appropriate explanation.	Discusses the roles of the teacher and learners but with limited depth or clarity.	Provides minimal or unclear discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners.
Application to Practice Teaching (25%)	Clearly explains how the philosophy will guide specific teaching practices, classroom decisions, and interactions with diverse learners.	Explains how the philosophy can guide future teaching practice with relevant examples.	Provides general connections to future teaching practice with limited examples.	Makes little or no connection between the philosophy and future teaching practice.
Reflection and Professional Identity (25%)	Demonstrates deep self-reflection and clearly connects personal experiences and insights to the development of a professional teaching identity.	Demonstrates thoughtful reflection and makes relevant connections to professional growth.	Includes some reflection but connections to professional identity are limited.	Shows little evidence of reflection or developing professional identity.

MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

NAME OF PRE-SERVICE TEACHER: Jade Lormie T. Porras

TITLE: Opening Many Paths to Learning

When I think about what makes a good teacher, I no longer think first about how much the teacher knows. I think about whether every student can find a way into the lesson. In one classroom there are learners who understand by listening, others by watching, and others only when they can hold the material and try it themselves. I believe that teaching is about opening different paths to learning so that every student has a fair chance to discover what they can do, build confidence, and grow. I am still a pre-service teacher and I still have a lot to learn, but this belief is the starting point of how I want to teach.

I believe students learn best when they take part and are not only listening. Learning is not just receiving information. Students build their understanding by connecting new lessons to what they already know and by trying things out. This is the idea behind constructivism and experiential learning, which say that people learn by doing, thinking about what happened, and applying it again. I also believe that learners are different in their prior knowledge, their pace, their confidence, and the resources they have at home. Because of this, one way of teaching will never reach everyone. This is why student-centered teaching and differentiated instruction make sense to me: the lesson is planned around the learners, not only around the teacher. I also believe that mistakes are part of learning. A student who is afraid to be wrong will stop trying, so I want mistakes to be treated as information we can use to improve.

For me, the teacher is a guide, a facilitator, an encourager, and a provider of learning opportunities. The teacher explains clearly and demonstrates, but then steps back and lets students try, so they do not feel that someone else will always do the work for them. Guiding should never make a student feel incapable. When a student is stuck, I would rather ask a question that points them in the right direction than give the answer right away, and I would give more support only as much as the student needs. The learner also has an active role. Students are responsible for asking questions, practicing, taking care of tools and materials, and helping their classmates. Learning is also social. Students often understand an idea better when a classmate explains it in simple words, and the one explaining learns even more. I believe learning grows when trust and cooperation between the teacher and the students grow together.

My faith is an important part of who I am. It teaches me to serve others, to be kind and humble, to be fair, and to see the value of every person. I want these values to show in how I treat my students and not in what I tell them to believe. I will not force my religion on anyone or expect my students to share my faith. A teacher can stay faithful to personal values and still respect the freedom, dignity, and individuality of every learner. In my classroom, a student should feel welcome, safe, and accepted no matter their religion or beliefs, background, abilities, personality, or financial situation. They should be able to share their ideas respectfully without fear of being judged. I will try to give everyone an equal chance to take part, and I will not favor any student because of their beliefs or background. For me, faith is shown through fairness, honesty, and service, through actions that students can actually see.

These beliefs shape how I want to teach Computer Hardware, a subject that cannot be learned from lectures alone. I would demonstrate first, for example how to identify components, how to assemble and disassemble a computer properly, and how to handle parts safely. Then I would let students do it themselves through guided practice, troubleshooting, and experimentation, followed by a short reflection on what they did and why. A mistake such as a wrongly seated memory module or an unconnected cable can become a good lesson when it happens safely and we look for the cause together. Safety is not negotiable: unplugging equipment, using tools correctly, and protecting components from static and damage. Because students come with different levels of experience, I

would give clear step-by-step instructions and extra guidance to those who need it, while encouraging faster learners to take on harder troubleshooting tasks and help their groupmates. Not every student has a computer at home, so I would make sure each one gets enough hands-on time with the equipment we have, using pair or group work when needed. Teamwork, responsibility, and proper care of tools are also skills of a technician, and I want students to practice them in class.

My Field Study experiences helped me see these ideas in a real school. Being inside real classrooms showed me that planning for all learners is harder than it sounds. In Field Study 2, I observed classes and wrote observation notes with my group for our action research, and I prepared a daily lesson plan for a Grade 10 TLE – ICT class with the guidance of my cooperating teacher. My cooperating teacher's instructions on how the plan should be arranged taught me that a good lesson plan has to fit the class and the school, not only my own ideas. Writing a group activity with clear instructions and a rubric also made me realize how important it is for students to know what is expected of them before they start, so no one is left guessing. The lesson was not about computer hardware, but I could see that the same principle applies: an activity should give every student something meaningful to do. I also learned that I still need to improve in managing time, in giving instructions that are short and clear, and in handling a class where learners are at different levels at the same time. I am still learning these things, and I welcome feedback.

When I plan lessons, I will start by asking what my students already know and what resources they have, and I will prepare more than one way to explain or practice the same skill, such as a demonstration, a guide sheet, and a hands-on task. In class, I will mix short explanations with guided practice, and I will use group work so students can support one another. For diverse learners, I will give extra guidance without making anyone feel different, and I will give extension tasks to those who finish early. When I give feedback, I will first say what the student did well, then what to improve and how, and I will share the rubric early so the standards are clear from the start. For classroom management, I will set simple expectations about respect, safety, and the care of equipment, and I will apply them fairly to everyone. After each activity, I will ask students to reflect on what worked, what did not, and what they would do differently. I will ask the same questions about my own teaching.

I hope to become a teacher whom students can approach, who is fair to everyone, and who believes in them even when they are still unsure of themselves. I want them to leave my class with technical skills, but also with confidence, responsibility, and respect for others. I accept that teaching will not always be easy and that I will make mistakes along the way, just as my students will. I commit to keep learning from my experiences, from feedback, and from my students. My promise as a pre-service teacher is to keep looking for another path whenever a student cannot yet find one, so that everyone in my classroom has a real chance to learn and to feel that they belong.